

1. Organisation Information

1.1 About Yayasan MENDAKI

Yayasan MENDAKI (Majlis Pendidikan Anak-Anak Islam, or the Council for the Education of Muslim Children) is a Malay/Muslim self-help group established in 1982 in Singapore. MENDAKI was founded to uplift the educational achievements and socio-economic standing of the Malay/Muslim community in Singapore. Over the decades, it has expanded its scope beyond education to encompass community development, skills training, and youth empowerment programs.

MENDAKI Club, operating under Yayasan MENDAKI, serves as the youth arm of the organization. It focuses on developing young people through structured programs that foster leadership, community engagement, and personal growth. The club operates from Wisma MENDAKI, located at 51 Kee Sun Avenue, Singapore 457056.

1.2 Mission & Vision

Mission: To empower the Malay/Muslim community through educational excellence, character development, and community engagement, enabling every individual to contribute meaningfully to a multi-racial and multi-religious Singapore.

Vision: A community of excellence that is confident, competent, and of strong character, actively contributing to the well-being of Singapore.

1.3 The PEER Community Programme

The PEER (Positive Engagement through Experiential Relationships) Community Program is a 6-month structured community mentorship initiative run under MENDAKI Club and Yayasan MENDAKI. The program pairs trained volunteer mentors with secondary school students (aged 11–16) to provide support, encouragement, and positive role models through carefully curated activities focused on experiential learning and developmental relationships.

The program runs biweekly every Saturday, with two concurrent programs held in Woodlands and Tampines, supported by M3@Woodlands and M3@Tampines, respectively. The current cycle runs from February to August 2026, spanning 12 sessions.

1.4 Staff and Participants

- Volunteer mentors and programme organisers: 90+
- Participating mentees: 60+
- Each mentor team consists of 2 mentors overseeing 3 mentees
- The support structure includes group leads and department heads who assist mentors as needed

1.5 The 5Cs Framework

The PEER program is built upon the 5Cs framework of Positive Youth Development, which guides all mentoring interactions and activity design. The framework was introduced to mentors during the onboarding session on 7 February 2026. The five elements are as follows:

Element	Description	Programme Objective
Competence	Positive view of one's actions in social, academic, cognitive, and vocational areas.	Increase competency in social development, academic achievement, and life skills.
Confidence	Internal sense of positive self-worth, self-efficacy, positive identity, and belief in the future.	Improved sense of positive self-worth and belief in the future through consistent encouragement and reinforcement.
Connection	Positive bonds with people and institutions, peers, family, school, and community, in which both parties contribute.	Development of a positive bond with the mentor and positive relationships with teachers, friends, family, and community.
Character	Respect for societal and cultural rules, a sense of right and wrong, spirituality, integrity, caring, and empathy for others.	Strengthen character as mentors introduce youth to positive values, hold them to high expectations, and model those behaviors.
Contribution	Active participation in family, school, and community activities and issues; development of leadership skills.	Youth are provided opportunities to meaningfully contribute back to the community and learn from their experiences.

1.6 Programme Timeline

The full programme spans 12 sessions from February to August 2026, with a Hari Raya break in between. The schedule of activities is as follows:

Session	Activity	Team	Date
Session 1	Orientation	FG	14 February 2026
Session 2	Community Session 1	CA	28 February 2026
Session 3	Social Session – Bonding	BS/GS	14 March 2026
<i>Hari Raya Break (21 March – 10 April 2026)</i>			
Session 4	Social Session – Bonding	FG	11 April 2026
Session 5	Squad Outing	CM	25 April 2026
Session 6	Social Session	BS/GS	9 May 2026
Session 7	Squad Outing	CM	23 May 2026
Session 8	Career Session	FG	6 June 2026
Session 9	Life Skill Session	BS/GS	20 June 2026
Session 10	Squad Outing	CM	4 July 2026
Session 11	Community Session 2	CA	18 July 2026
Session 12	Closing	FG	1 August 2026

2. Theme-Based Event: Building Trust and Teamwork Through Creative Expression

2.1 Learning Objectives

- To foster a sense of trust and belonging among mentees within their mentor-mentee groups through collaborative creative activities.

- To encourage self-expression and open communication among mentees using art and play as mediums.
- To develop teamwork and cooperation skills that align with the 5Cs framework, specifically Competence, Connection, and Character.
- To create a safe and non-judgmental space where mentees feel comfortable sharing their thoughts and emotions.

2.2 Introduction

This theme-based event was conducted across two sessions: Session 3 (14 March 2026) and Session 4 (11 April 2026) under the broader theme of “Building Trust and Teamwork Through Creative Expression.” The rationale behind this theme was rooted in the understanding that adolescents (aged 11–16) often find it difficult to express themselves verbally, especially in unfamiliar group settings. Creative activities such as drawing, art-based exercises, and board games serve as non-threatening mediums that lower psychological barriers to communication and encourage organic bonding.

From a clinical psychology perspective, creative expression and play-based interventions are well-established approaches for facilitating emotional expression and building rapport with young people. These methods align with principles from art therapy and group therapy, where structured activities serve as catalysts for interpersonal connection.

2.3 Body of Content

Session 3 (14 March 2026) Social Session (Bonding): This session was designed as the first major bonding activity with mentees. The session began with an icebreaker drawing activity where each mentee was asked to draw something that represented them, a hobby, a favorite place, or an emotion. This served as a springboard for conversation, allowing mentors to learn about the mentees’ interests and personalities without direct questioning, which can sometimes feel intimidating for younger participants.

Following the drawing activity, the group transitioned into board games. Games were selected to encourage teamwork rather than competition, requiring mentees to communicate, strategise, and

collaborate. Throughout the session, mentors facilitated discussions about teamwork, listening to others, and respecting different perspectives. Mentees were observed to gradually open up as the session progressed, moving from initial shyness to active participation and laughter.

Session 4 (11 April 2026) Social Session (Bonding): Building upon the foundation established in Session 3, this session continued the theme of creative expression and bonding after the Hari Raya break. This time, activities incorporated reflective elements where mentees were encouraged to share what they had been doing during the break and what they were looking forward to in the program. The session included group-based art activities that required collaboration. Each mentor-mentee group worked together on a shared creative piece, reinforcing the sense of belonging and team identity.

Mentors observed a noticeable difference in the mentees' comfort levels compared to earlier sessions. Mentees who had been quiet during Session 1 were now initiating conversations and actively participating. This progression validated the developmental approach of the programme, where trust is built incrementally through consistent positive interactions.

2.4 Summary

The theme-based event across sessions 3 and 4 successfully achieved its objectives of fostering trust, encouraging self-expression, and developing teamwork among mentees. The use of creative and play-based activities proved effective in breaking down initial barriers and creating a warm, inclusive group environment. The progression from cautious participation to genuine engagement demonstrated the value of consistent, structured mentoring interactions. These sessions directly reinforced the 5Cs of Competence (through skill-building in collaboration), Connection (through strengthened mentor-mentee bonds), and Character (through learning to respect and empathize with peers).

3. Activities Conducted

3.1 Activity 1: Orientation and First Meeting with Mentees

Date: 14 February 2026

Session: Session 1 – Orientation (Full Group)

Procedure:

The orientation session marked the first official meeting between mentors and mentees in the PEER program. Prior to this, mentors had undergone an onboarding session on 7 February 2026, where they were trained on the 5Cs framework, programme expectations, and do's and don'ts of mentoring. The department also conducted mock rounds to simulate how mentees might behave, including scenarios where mentees would be reluctant to engage or might test boundaries.

During the orientation, mentees were introduced to their assigned mentor groups. Each group comprised two mentors and three mentees. The session began with structured icebreaker activities designed to ease tension and facilitate initial introductions. Mentors introduced themselves and shared a bit about their backgrounds, and mentees were encouraged (but not pressured) to do the same.

Mentees were also given their reflection journals — personal booklets in which they would record their learnings, reflections, and motivations after each session. Mentors explained the purpose of these journals as a tool for self-reflection and growth throughout the program.

Learning Outcomes and Reflection:

As anticipated during the mock rounds, the mentees were initially reserved and hesitant to open up during this first meeting. However, the structured icebreakers helped reduce awkwardness and provided a comfortable starting point. As a clinical psychology student, I recognized the importance of not rushing the rapport-building process. The onboarding training had emphasized that trust is built over time, and this first session was about planting the seeds for a safe and supportive relationship. The experience reinforced the value of patience and active listening in working with adolescents.

3.2 Activity 2: Ramadan Community Outreach – Food and Rations Distribution

Date: 28 February 2026

Session: Session 2 – Community Session 1

Procedure:

This community session was timed for the month of Ramadan and designed to instill values of compassion, empathy, and community responsibility in the mentees. The activity involved visiting underprivileged homes to distribute food and rations to families in need.

Before the distribution, mentors conducted a brief discussion with the mentees about the importance of giving back to the community, the ethics of community service (such as treating recipients with dignity and respect), and the significance of Ramadan as a month of reflection and generosity. Mentees were actively involved in the preparation, organizing the rations, planning the distribution route, and learning about the communities they would be serving.

During the distribution itself, mentees worked alongside their mentors, handing out food packages and engaging respectfully with the recipients. After the activity, the group gathered for a debrief where mentees shared their thoughts and reflections on the experience. Many mentees expressed that the activity had given them a new perspective on privilege and the importance of community solidarity.

Learning Outcomes and Reflection:

This session was particularly impactful as it brought the 5Cs framework to life, specifically the elements of character (ethics, empathy, and compassion) and contribution (active participation in community activities). The mentees demonstrated maturity and sensitivity during the distribution, and several of them reflected thoughtfully in their journals about what the experience meant to them. From a clinical psychology perspective, community-based experiential activities like this can have a significant positive impact on adolescents' prosocial development and their sense of purpose and belonging.

3.3 Future Sessions and Upcoming Activities

The PEER program continues with several more sessions planned through August 2026. Key upcoming activities include:

- Session 5 (25 April 2026) – Squad Outing: A self-planned outing by the mentor-mentee group, designed to strengthen group bonds through a shared experience chosen by the team. This session was postponed and will be rescheduled.
- Session 6 (9 May 2026) – Social Session: A boys/girls segmented social session that allows for gender-specific conversations and experiences in a more comfortable setting.
- Sessions 7 & 10 – Squad Outings: Additional self-planned group outings to further deepen mentor-mentee relationships.
- Session 8 (6 June 2026) – Career Session: An exploratory session aimed at broadening mentees’ awareness of career pathways and aspirations.
- Session 9 (20 June 2026) – Life Skill Session: Practical life skills workshop to build competency and independence among mentees.
- Session 11 (18 July 2026) – Community Session 2: A second community engagement activity to reinforce the values of contribution and service.
- Session 12 (1 August 2026) – Closing: The final session to celebrate the journey, reflect on growth, and mark the completion of the program cycle.

4. Overall Learning Outcomes and Reflection

My journey with the PEER Community Program began on 7 February 2026 with the mentor onboarding session, where I was introduced to the 5Cs framework, program protocols, and the expectations of a mentor. The mock rounds conducted by the department were invaluable. They prepared me for the reality that mentees would not immediately open up, and that building trust requires consistent effort and patience. This understanding proved especially relevant given my

background in clinical psychology, where therapeutic rapport is recognized as the foundation for any meaningful intervention.

Over the course of the sessions conducted so far, I have witnessed a clear progression in the mentor-mentee relationship. During Session 1 (Orientation), the mentees were visibly guarded and unsure of what to expect. By Session 3 (Drawing and Board Games), they were beginning to relax, express themselves, and engage with activities more willingly. By Session 4 (post-Hari Raya bonding), the dynamic had shifted significantly. Mentees were initiating conversations, laughing freely, and showing genuine enthusiasm for the program. This gradual progression mirrors what we study in clinical psychology about the stages of relationship building and the importance of creating a psychologically safe environment.

The community outreach during Ramadan (Session 2) was a turning point for many of the mentees. It brought real-world relevance to the program and allowed the mentees to practice empathy and social responsibility tangibly. As a clinical psychology student, I was particularly attentive to how the mentees processed this experience emotionally — many of them reflected on privilege, community, and their own roles in society in ways that demonstrated genuine cognitive and emotional growth.

The feedback loop built into the program, where mentees write reflections in their journals and mentors submit feedback to the department, is an effective mechanism for continuous improvement. It ensures that the program remains responsive to the mentees' needs and that mentors receive the guidance and support they require from group leads and department heads.

Working alongside my co-mentor has also been a valuable learning experience. Having two mentors per group allows for different perspectives and complementary strengths and ensures that no mentee is overlooked. The coordination between mentors, group leads, and department heads creates a robust support system that benefits both mentors and mentees.

In summary, this field placement has been deeply enriching both personally and academically. It has allowed me to apply concepts from clinical psychology, such as rapport building, developmental psychology, group dynamics, and prosocial behavior in a real-world community setting. The PEER program exemplifies how structured mentoring, grounded in a solid developmental framework like the 5Cs, can meaningfully support the growth and well-being of

young people. I look forward to the remaining sessions and the continued development of my mentees as they grow in competence, confidence, connection, character, and contribution.